

A. leptopus. Fast-growing, evergreen, woody-stemmed, tendrill climber. H 20ft (6m). Has crinkly, pale green leaves. Dense trusses of bright pink, sometimes red or white, flowers grow mainly in summer, but all year in tropical conditions. Z15 (min. 59°F/15°C)

ANTIRRHINUM

Snapdragon

PLANTAGINACEAE/SCROPHULARIACEAE

Genus of perennials and semievergreen subshrubs, usually grown as annuals, flowering from spring to fall. Needs sun and rich, well-drained soil. Deadhead to prolong flowering season. Propagate by seed sown outdoors in late spring or by stem cuttings in early fall or spring. Rust disease may be a problem with *A. majus*, but rust-resistant cultivars are available.

A. asarina. See *Asarina procumbens*.

A. majus. Erect, short-lived perennial, usually grown as a bedding annual, which branches from the base. Cultivars are grown as annuals and are grouped according to size and flower type: tall, H 2–3ft (60cm–1m), S 12–18in (30–45cm); intermediate, H and S 18in (45cm); dwarf, H 8–12in (20–30cm), S 12in (30cm); regular tubular-shaped (hyacinth-like) flowers; penstemon, trumpet-shaped flowers; double; and irregular tubular-shaped flowers. All have lance-shaped leaves and, from spring to fall, carry spikes of usually 2-lipped, sometimes double, flowers in a variety of colors, including white, pink, red, purple, yellow and orange. Z9–11.

Antiquity Mixed (intermediate, penstemon) is branching, producing scented, bicolored flowers in white and shades of pink, purple and dark red.

Appeal Series (dwarf, regular) is compact, with flowers in a wide range of colors, including some bicolors. **‘Black Prince’** illus. p.306. **Liberty Classic Series** cultivars (intermediate, regular) are free-flowering and rust-resistant; strong stems carry flowers in colors that include white, yellow, orange, red and pink. **‘Bronze’** flowers open pink and fade to orange. **‘Liberty Yellow’** illus. p.320.

‘Liberty Scarlet’ illus. p.310. **Madame Butterfly Series** cultivars (tall, double) are vigorous, with azalea-like double flowers in a wide range of colors; good for cut flowers. **‘Night and Day’** (intermediate, regular) has dark crimson-and-white flowers. **Rocket Series** (tall, regular) are vigorous, with flowers in a broad color range; excellent for cut flowers. **Sonnet Series** (intermediate, regular) are bushy, with flowers in a variety of colors. **Twinny Series** (dwarf, semidouble to double) produces large flowers that are densely packed on the stems; colors include white, yellow, pink, red and violet. **‘Twinny Appleblossom’** has pale pink flowers that age to creamy white. **‘Twinny Peach’** has orange-pink flowers.

APHELANDRA

ACANTHACEAE

Genus of evergreen shrubs and subshrubs with attractive, showy flowers. Grows best in bright light but out of direct sun in

summer. Use soft water and keep soil moist but not waterlogged. Benefits from feeding when flower spikes are forming. Propagate by seed or tip cuttings from young stems in spring.

A. squarrosa (Zebra plant). **‘Dania’** is an evergreen, compact perennial. H and S 12in (30cm). Ovate, glossy, dark green leaves, with white veins and midribs, are nearly 1ft (30cm) long. Dense, 4-sided spikes, to 6in (15cm) long, of 2-lipped, bright yellow flowers form in axils of yellow bracts in fall. **‘Louisae’** illus. p.476. Z14–15 (min. 45–50°F/7–10°F, optimum 66°F/19°C)

APHYLLANTHES

ASPARAGACEAE

Genus of one species of summer-flowering perennial. Grow in a sunny, warm, sheltered corner, preferably in an alpine house, and in well-drained, sandy, peaty soil. Resents disturbance. Propagate by seed in fall or spring.

A. monspeliensis. Tuft-forming perennial. H 4–10in (10–25cm), sometimes to 16in (40cm), S 4–6in (10–15cm). Star-shaped, pale to deep blue flowers are borne singly or in small groups at tops of wiry, glaucous green stems from early to midsummer. Leaves are reduced to red-brown sheaths surrounding stems. Z9–10

APONOGETON

APONOGETONACEAE

Genus of deciduous, perennial, deep-water plants, grown for their floating foliage and often heavily scented flowers. Requires an open, sunny position. Tidy fading foliage in fall. Propagate by division in spring or by seed while still fresh.

A. distachyos (Cape pondweed, Water hawthorn) illus. p.435.

Aporocactus flagelliformis. See *Disocactus flagelliformis*

APTENIA

AIZOACEAE

Genus of fast-growing, perennial succulents, with trailing, freely branching stems, that form good groundcover. Needs full sun and well-drained soil. Keep dry in winter. Propagate by seed or stem cuttings in spring or summer.

A. cordifolia, syn. *Mesembryanthemum cordifolium*, illus. p.484. **‘Variegata’** is a fast-growing, prostrate, perennial succulent. H 2in (5cm), S indefinite. Has ovate, glossy, bright green leaves, with creamy-white margins, and small, daisylike, bright pink flowers in summer. Z12–15

AQUILEGIA

Columbine

RANUNCULACEAE

Genus of graceful, clump-forming, often short-lived perennials, grown for their mainly bell-shaped, spurred flowers in spring and summer. Suitable for rock gardens. Prefers an open, sunny site and well-drained soil. Propagate species by seed in fall or spring. Selected forms only

occasionally come true from seed (e.g. *A. vulgaris* ‘Nora Barlow’) as they cross freely; segregate them widely. Prone to aphid attack. ☹ Contact with sap may irritate skin.

A. akitensis. See *A. flabellata* var. *pumila*.

A. alpina (Alpine columbine) illus. p.334.

A. atrata (Black columbine). Clump-forming perennial H 24–28in (60–70 cm), S 12in (30cm). Bell-shaped, fluted, deep purple-violet flowers with spreading sepals and short ½in (1cm)-long, strongly hooked spurs are borne in early summer above mid-green, glaucous-backed leaves divided into 9 segments. Z4–8

A. bertolonii, syn. *A. reuteri*. Clump-forming, compact perennial. H to 12in (30cm), S 4in (10cm). Bell-shaped, blue-violet flowers with spreading sepals and short, ½in- (1cm-) long curved spurs are borne in late spring and early summer over dark green leaves divided into 9 segments. Z4–7

A. Biedermeier Group. Short-stemmed, compact perennials. H 20in (50cm), S 12in (30cm). Almost upward-facing, open-bell-shaped flowers in colors varying from purple-blue to lilac, red, pink or white are borne from late spring to midsummer above divided, bluish-green foliage. Z4–7

A. ‘Bluebird’ (Songbird Series; illus. p.226). Clump-forming, compact perennial. H 24–28in (60–70cm), S 14–16in (35–40 cm). Bears large, open bell-shaped, fluted flowers with white petals, soft, pale violet-blue sepals and long, slightly curved spurs in late spring and early summer above fernlike, divided, mid-green leaves. Z4–9

A. ‘Bunting’ (Songbird Series; illus. p.226). Clump-forming, compact perennial. H 2ft (60cm), S 12–14in (30–35cm). Open bell-shaped, fluted flowers with white, blue-flushed petals, violet-blue sepals and long spurs are produced in late spring and early summer above fernlike, divided, mid-green leaves. Z4–9

A. canadensis (Canadian columbine; illus. p.226). Clump-forming, leafy perennial. H 24–36in (60–90cm), S 12in (30cm). In early summer, bears semipendent, bell-shaped flowers, with yellow sepals and red spurs, several per slender stem, above fernlike, dark green foliage. Z3–8

A. ‘Cardinal’ (Songbird Series). Clump-forming, compact perennial. H 20in (50cm), S 12–14in (30–35cm). Open bell-shaped, fluted flowers with white petals, deep red-pink at the base, dark red sepals and long, curved spurs are borne in late spring and early summer above fernlike, divided, mid-green leaves. Z4–8

A. chrysantha (Yellow columbine; illus. p.226). Vigorous, clump-forming perennial. H 3ft (90cm), S 2ft (60cm). In early summer, produces semipendent, bell-shaped, pale to bright yellow flowers, with long spurs, several per stem. Has fernlike, divided, mid-green leaves. Z3–8. **‘Yellow Queen’** has golden-yellow flowers.

A. coerulea (Rocky mountain columbine) illus. p.226. Upright perennial. H 2ft (60cm), S 12in (30cm). Almost upward-facing flowers, with open-spreading white sepals, pale to deep sky-blue petals and long spurs are borne from late spring to midsummer above mid-green, divided leaves. Z4–7

A. ‘Dove’ (Songbird Series; illus. p.226). Clump-forming, compact perennial. H 30in

(75cm), S 14–16in (35–40cm). Open bell-shaped, fluted, large flowers with white petals, sepals and long spurs, are borne in late spring and early summer above fernlike, divided, light green leaves. Z4–9

A. ‘Dragonfly’ (illus. p.226). Upright perennial. H 2ft (60cm), S 12in (30cm). Bell-shaped, upright to semihorizontally-placed, fluted, large flowers with yellow, basally red-flushed petals and purplish-red sepals and spurs are produced from late spring to midsummer above fernlike, mid-green, divided leaves. Z4–7

A. flabellata. Clump-forming perennial. H 4–12in (10–30cm), S 4–6in (10–15cm). Bell-shaped, soft blue flowers, each with fluted petals and a short spur, are produced in summer. Rounded, finely divided leaves form an open, basal rosette. Needs semishade and moist soil. Z4–9.

var. alba ‘White Jewel’ has white flowers. **‘Nana Alba’** see A.f. var. *pumila* f. *alba*. **var. pumila** (syn. *A. akitensis*; illus. p.226) grows to 6in (15cm) and has deep blue and white petals. **var. pumila f. alba** (syn. A.f. ‘Nana Alba’), H to 4in (10cm), is compact and has white flowers.

A. ‘Florida’ (State Series). Clump-forming, upright perennial. H 30in (75cm), S 12in (30cm). Bears open, bell-shaped, fluted flowers with long spurs, mid-yellow petals and creamy-yellow, spreading sepals, in late spring and early summer, above fernlike, divided, light green leaves. Z4–8

A. fragrans. Upright perennial. H 6–16in (15–40cm), S 6–8in (15–20cm). Nodding, bell-shaped, fragrant flowers with creamy-white petals and bluish- or pinkish-white sepals and spurs to ¾in (2cm) long are produced in midsummer above finely divided bluish-green leaves. Z4–8

A. ‘Goldfinch’ (Songbird Series). Clump-forming, compact perennial. H 24–28in (60–70cm), S 14in (35cm). Has open bell-shaped, fluted flowers with bright yellow petals, sepals and long spurs in late spring and early summer above fernlike, divided, mid-green leaves. Z4–8

A. ‘Hensol Harebell’ (illus. p.226). Clump-forming, compact perennial. H 30in (75cm), S 12in (30cm). In late spring, tall, slender stems bear pendent, bell-shaped, short-spurred, soft blue flowers above fernlike, divided, pale green leaves. Z4–7

A. jonesii illus. p.368.

A. karelinii. Clump-forming perennial. H 8–32in (20–80cm), S 5–12in (12–30cm) . Nodding, bell-shaped flowers with violet to wine-purple petals, spreading sepals and short, hooked spurs are produced above the light green, slightly glaucous leaves in early summer. Z3–9

A. longissima (illus. p.226). Clump-forming, leafy perennial. H 24–36in (60–90cm), S 45cm (18cm). Bell-shaped, pale yellow flowers, with very long, bright yellow spurs, are borne, several per stem, in early summer, above fernlike, divided, mid-green leaves. Z4–9

A. ‘Louisiana’. Upright perennial. H to 2ft (60cm) or more, S 14in (35cm). Large, upward-facing flowers, with long, red spurs, red sepals and white petals, are borne on branching stems from late spring to midsummer. Has fernlike, divided, mid-green leaves. Z5–9

A. ‘Mrs. Scott Elliott’. See A. Mrs. Scott Elliott Hybrids.